

The First Anniversary Mass for Kevin Kelly, Bancran Rd, will be held on Friday 23 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for John Joe McKenna, Cloane Rd, will be held on Friday 23 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

Agnes Gray, Corrick Rd.;
Patrick McCullagh, Coolnasillagh Rd.;
Eileen Devlin, Sixtowns Rd.;
John McGorry, Oak Park;
Peggy Sargent, Gortnaskea Rd.;
Michael McGlone, Tonagh Hgts.;
Ellen Murray, Belfast;
Brendan McBride, Cavanreagh Rd.;
Susan Murray, Ranaghan Rd.;
Delphine McKenna, The Square;
Monica Gillespie, Glenelly Villas.

Desertmartin:

Brendan O'Neill;
Willie Fullen;
John Murray;
Maggie McGuigan;
Mary Donnelly;
Mary Josephine Breen.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism: Naoise Eamonn Mac Giolla Bhrighde, Dromdallagan

DO THIS IN MEMORY OF ME ENROLMENT MASS

The first DTIM mass is the 'Enrolment Mass', for ALL the children of the parish preparing for First Holy Communion next year and will take place on **Saturday 10 October in Holy Rosary Church at 6.00 pm Vigil Mass.**

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £1901
Renovation Collection - £1668.10
Retired Priests Collection - £229

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1150
Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

VOCATIONS

Are you 18 years or older, wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? An afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry on Sunday 11 October. For further details contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com

OUR LADY, UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA

Novena begins after the 7.30 pm Mass on Thursday 1 October in Saint Eugene's Cathedral. Continuing for the following eight Thursdays, concluding on 26 November. Do you have "knots" in your life. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care - learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join.

ST. COLM'S HIGH SCHOOL

St. Colm's High School Harvest Mass will take place in the Holy Rosary Church on Tuesday 13 October at 2.00 pm. Everyone welcome.

MONTHLY LUNCHEON CLUB

Free Transport now available to Over 60s Monthly Luncheon Club in Workspace Community Hub. Monthly Luncheon Club takes place on Wednesday 21 October in Workspace Community Hub from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. Workspace is teaming up with Out and About Community Transport to provide free transport to anyone in the Ballinascreen area who would like to attend but doesn't have access to transport. If you would like more information on booking a free spot, please contact Workspace on 028 7962 8113 before Wednesday 14 October and join us for a delicious lunch and good company, in a warm and friendly atmosphere.

BALLINASCREEN HISTORICAL SOCIETY

A talk entitled "The Drapers' Company Tenantry" by Alistair Bodkin will be held on Tuesday 6 October at 8.00 pm in the Community Hub. Copies of his books will undoubtedly provide a rich resource for family history, emigration and even nicknames will be on sale. Everyone welcome.

FÉILE BHAILE NA SCRÍNE - BALLINASCREEN FESTIVAL

Glór na Speiríní are delighted to announce a range of bilingual activities for all ages as part of our week-long festival.

Wednesday 7 October: Gaeilge Go For It! from 7.00 pm to 8.00 pm. An insight from parents, pupils of Irish medium students and the perspective of adult learners. If you are wondering about learning Irish or choosing Irish medium education for your child. Not to be missed!

Friday 9 October: Pop-Up Gaeltacht, open music session, singing, conversation & craic in The Market Inn from 9.00 pm to late proceeds in aid of Palestine.

Saturday 10 October: Bilingual guided walk around Loch na gCon (Lough Fea) meeting at the carpark at 10.00 am

Sunday 11 October: Family Fun Day in An Ráth Dubh from 1.00 pm to 3.00 pm. Donations at the door in aid of youth club.

For more info on any of these events please contact Conchúr on 79627703 or email conchurglor@gmail.com

BALLINASCREEN CREDIT UNION

September Quarterly Cash Draw Winners:

First Prize - £10,000 Mr Seamus Bradley, Plumbridge.

Second Prize - £7,000 Mr Sean Óg Scullion, Carnamoney Lane.

Third Prize - £5,000 Miss Cathy McKenna, Cloane Road.

Fourth Prize - £3,000 Mr Sean McConnell, Gortin.

Next Quarterly Cash Draw Saturday 19 December 2026.

BIRTHDAY WISHES

Congratulations and Happy Birthday to James Henry of Brooklands Nursing Home, formally Fivemilestraight, who celebrated his 104th Birthday this week.

CONGRATULATIONS

Congratulations to the Desertmartin Ladies Team who won the recent County Championship Final.

KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Social Tea Dance: Friday 9 October, at 9.00 pm. Music by Colin Harney. Admission £7 - including refreshments.

Salsa Dancing: 6-week Salsa Dancing class is perfect for beginners no previous experience or partner needed! Thursday 1 October from 7.00 pm to 8:30 pm. Cost: £42 for the 6-week block.

Craft Fair: A few tables still available for our Christmas Craft Fair, Sunday 8 November from 10:30 am to 3.00 pm. £20 per table or 2 for £30, £10 booking deposit. email knocknaginhc@gmail.com or 078 8761 4094

Irish Class; Mondays. **Bunrang (Beginners)** 6:45pm to 8pm. **Meánrang (Improvers)** 8pm to 9:30pm.

Chair Exercise: Tuesdays from 10.00 am to 11.00 am. All welcome. Admission £4.

Irish Dancing Lessons: Tuesday evenings from 5:30 pm to 7.00 pm To register, contact Nicola: 07518 207458

Bowling Club: Tuesdays from 8.00 pm. Suitable for all.

Céilí Dancing Classes: New 6-week block started on Wednesday 30 September at 7:30pm. Suitable for all ages.

Acrobats Gymnastics Club: Saturdays from 9.00 am to 2.00 pm. To register visit <https://acro-bats.classforkids.io/term/10>

Sarsfield's Accordion Band: Practice on Thursday at 7:30 pm. New and past members are all very welcome.

SGARA

Crochet classes start in Knocknagin hall on Tuesday 6th October at 7.30pm to 9pm all welcome limited places. Contact Chris 07546010560

Dance in Knocknagin Hall: Sunday 18 October from 3.00 pm to 5.30 pm. Music by Sean Corrigan.

SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP

Indoor Bowls: Mondays at 8.15 pm. New Members Welcome.

Special 25th Anniversary: Celebration event will be held on Friday 9 October at 8.00 pm in Sixtowns Hall. A great night of music & entertainment has been arranged with special guests Country Harmony, Patsy O'Hagan, Justin McGurk, Hugo Duncan and Brendan Quinn. Tickets are £20 and available from The Shepherd's Rest, Herons Chemist, Ballinascreen Credit Union, Straw Service Station & Committee Members.

Christmas Fair with Santa: Sunday 29th November 2026 at Sixtowns Hall. Tables are booking up fast. £20 per table or £30 for two. To book, contact 07769 289385

NUALA'S BEGINNER 6 WEEK FITNESS CLASS

Join Nuala's classes for an exciting new Beginner Fitness Class designed to help you move, build confidence, and have fun! Classes - £3.50 per session. Perfect for absolute beginners, low impact & easy to follow. Starts Tuesday 13 October from 6.45 pm to 7.45 pm in the hall, Workspace

Recreation Centre on the Back row. Book your space by telephoning Carin: 02879628113.

NETBALL FOR BEGINNERS

Wednesday nights from 8.00 pm to 9.00 pm in the Backrow Hall. Over 16 ladies welcome. Come along for fun. No need to register Just turn up on the night. Adm £3. Contact Martina on 07795165999 for more info.

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

- 17 October, Sixtowns. (**Saturday**)
- 1 November, St. Columba's, Straw.
- 8 November, St Eugene's Moneyneena.
- 29 November, Holy Rosary Church.
- 6 December, St. Patrick's, Sixtowns.
- 13 December, St. Columba's, Straw.
- 20 December, St Eugene's Moneyneena.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

- October 18 2026
- November 8 & 22 2026
- December 6 & 20 2026
- January 10 & 24 2027
- February 7 & 21 2027
- March 7 & 14 2027
- April 4 & 18 2027

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

We pray for the men God is calling to serve as priests of our diocese that, as they work in the vineyard of the Lord, they will produce the good fruit of justice and integrity.

PARISH OF BANAGHER

27th Sunday in Ordinary Time – 4th October 2026

Mass Times Mass

Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 11th October 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12.00pm Noon

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

A First Anniversary Mass will be celebrated for the happy repose of the soul of Celine O'Connor, RIP, on Sunday 11th October in St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen at 12.00pm Noon.

October	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	David & Joanne Hassan	Sheena McGrellis	Maeve McLaughlin
Eucharistic Ministers	Darragh McCloskey	Briege O'Neill	
Flowers	Bridie McErlean		Corrine Coyle
Cleaning	Lorraine O'Kane, Marie French, Sarah McGrellis		Catherine Ball, Emma O'Connor
Counters	Liam & Siobhan Campbell, Pat McCullagh, Bernie McCullagh, Vincent McCloskey, Geraldine McCloskey		Olive O'Neill, Mary Conway, Betty McAteer
Collectors	Dermot O'Hara, Pat McCullagh	Jackie Hasson, Liam Campbell	Jimmy Barry Murphy, JT McCloskey



Banagher Parish Monthly Cash Prize Draw ~ Tickets on Sale!

Money raised will go towards the ongoing refurbishment and maintenance of our Churches

Draws for 10 Cash Prizes will take place in October, November and December.

- The **First Draw** will take place soon on **Friday 16th October**
- 30 chances to win! Tickets cost **£30** and are now on sale and available from our Church Sacristies and Parochial House and from Feeny Spar, Park Vivo, Mace Derrychrier and Sperrin View Bar. Thank you very much for your support.

Church Gate Collections for the Rise and Shine Trust (formally known as The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) to support its Easter 2027 Lourdes Pilgrimage will take place next Saturday and Sunday, 10th and 11th October at all churches.

Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests travelling with the Group. The application form is available online at <https://form.jotform.com/212932685135054> or visit riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications is 15th October 2026. Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications online at riseandshine.ie. For more information, visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian on 079 6021 1352 or Róisín on 00353 86 338 0328.

Readers for Foreglen We are looking for some more readers to offer to read at Sunday Mass in St. Peter's & St. Paul's, Foreglen. Your presence would be very welcome and would add to the celebration of our Sunday Masses. If you would like to help our church community and be a church reader, please contact Fr. Dermot or one of the other readers in the church.

Prayer for Vocations We pray for the men God is calling to serve as priests of our diocese that, as they work in the vineyard of the Lord, they will produce the good fruit of justice and integrity.

Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the Diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry on Sunday 11th October. For further details, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com.

The Power of Gathering - Book Launch You are invited to join us for a special evening to celebrate the launch of Fr. Paul Farren's new book, *The Power of Gathering*, which reflects on the gift of coming together as a community of faith and the importance of our gathering for the celebration of Mass. We would be delighted if you could join us for this special occasion on Wednesday 7th October at 7.00pm in St. Mary's College, Northland Road, Derry, BT48 0AN with Guest Speaker Bishop Michael Router. All are very welcome. 'For where two or three are gathered in my name, I am there among them.' [Matthew 18:20]

+ **CONFIRMATION DATES 2027** +

St. Canice's P.S., Feeny and St. Peter's & St. Paul's P.S., Foreglen: Saturday 17th April at 11.00am in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn.

St. Mary's P.S., Altinure: Saturday 17th April at 2.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

• **FIRST HOLY COMMUNION DATES 2027** •

St. Mary's P.S., Altinure: Saturday 8th May at **10.30am** in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

St. Peter's & St. Paul's P.S., Foreglen: Saturday 15th May at 11.00am in St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen.

St. Canice's P.S., Feeny: Saturday 22nd May at 11.00am in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn.

ACCORD Couple Counselling Our couples counselling specialists provide in-person and online services to individuals and couples dealing with relationship challenges. For further information and to make an appointment, please contact us: Accord Derry, Tel. 028 7136 2475; Email derry@accordni.com or Web: www.accordni.com.

Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

Feast Days

Wednesday 7th October: Our Lady of the Rosary The feast of the Holy Rosary was instituted by Pope Pius V to celebrate the anniversary of the defeat of the Turkish fleet at the battle of Lepanto on the first Sunday in October 1571, which ended the threat of Muslim domination of the Mediterranean and was ascribed in part to the prayers and processions of the Rosary confraternity in Rome. The feast was moved to the fixed date of 7th October.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

19^h & 20th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £1,495 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: £465

26th & 27th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £630 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: £675
St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: £740

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:

Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659

Thank you for your continued generosity.

COMMUNITY NEWS

Learmount Community Development Group (PARK): Week commencing Monday 5th October: **Monday 5th October:** Time For Me Ladies (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Dementia Social Group (11 am - 1 pm); Embroidery Class Week 1 (1.30 - 3.30 pm); Painting with Sheila: (7.30 - 9.30 pm); Ladies' Yoga (7 - 7.45 pm); Men's Yoga (8 - 8.45 pm); **Tuesday 6th October:** Men's Hobby Workshop (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Craft and Crochet Club (10.30 - 12.30 pm); Advice NW (2 - 4 pm); Funky Feet Kids dance class (5 - 6 pm); Learmount AGM (7.30 pm); **Wednesday 7th October:** Learmount Gardening Group (11 am); Natural Living Workshop with Blue Hare Crafts (7 - 9 pm); **Thursday 8th October:** Post Office Outreach Service (9 am - 12 pm); Painting for Pleasure (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Park 60+ Club (12 - 2 pm), Funky Feet Kids dance class (4.15 - 5.15 pm); **Friday 9th October:** Learmount Walking Group (10.30 am); Traditional music & signing group (no experience necessary: bring your instrument for some music and craic) - 8 pm (Resource Centre) **Dates for your diary: Friday 16th October:** Local History Walk in Partnership with the Stonemason's Cottage, Ballyrory, invites you to take a guided walk in Tireighter (Upper) area of Park opposite the Burn. An opportunity to connect with nature and to hear of the local heritage of the area. Meeting at the Community Centre at 10 am to car share. **Wednesday 28th October:** Free health checks with the Farm Families mobile van: Booking through the community Centre. For further details: Tel. 028 7778 1881 /WhatsApp 077 5111 8656 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org.

Learmount Community Development Group AGM: Takes place on Tuesday 6th October 2026 with guest speaker Brian O'Neill from Enterprise NW who will present on Learmount's strategic plan for the next 5 years. Everyone very welcome. Everyone who attends will be entered into a draw for a voucher for the Belfray.

Glenshane Community Development AGM will take place at Glenshane House on Friday 9th October at 7 pm. Everyone welcome. For further information, call 028 7774 2924.

65+ Safer Journeys – Limavady Road Victim Support NI & Donegal invites you to its FREE 65+ Safer Journeys event on Monday 12th October, 12noon–2pm at Roe Valley Arts & Cultural Centre, Limavady. provided. Free to attend. Funded by Causeway Coast & Glens PCSP. To book your place, call 077 1393 2971.

Lumen Christi College 30th Anniversary Gala event in the Everglades Hotel on Friday 23rd October: Night at the Races, meal and dancing! Tickets available from the college reception. All welcome.

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Parish Office opening hours: Monday to Friday: 9.30am - 12.30pm.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com

SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973

Bellaghy Parish Office: info@bellaghyparish.com 02879386259/ 07703444280

Office hours: Mon, Wed & Thurs 9am—3pm, Fri 8am—11am.

Office closed Tuesday. Website: www.bellaghyparish.com

St Vincent de Paul 07508549588

Greenlough Parish Office: greenloughparish@gmail.com Tel: 02825821190

Website: www.greenlough.com

St Ergnat's GAC— Lotto No's: 8, 12, 23, 24. £30 each to Brid Carey & Eilish Berry.
Jackpot £5,000.00

St Malachy's GAC— Lotto No's: 2, 3, 19, 20. £25 each to Mary McGovern & Leona McAteer . **Jackpot £2,400.00**

Ceili Class every Thursday night 8 - 9.30pm in the Parochial Hall (Opendoor Complex) Bellaghy. Everyone welcome.

"Kids Halloween Disco – ages 3-12 years. St John Bosco Community Hall, Ballynease on Thurs 29 Oct from 6.30-8.30. Live music by DJ JP, Tuck Shop, face painting and spot prizes for best fancy dress. Admission £3 per child.
This is a fundraiser by Mya McAllister. **All proceeds to School Aid Romania 2027."**

Bellaghy Historical Society: Next meeting on Tues 13 Oct at 8pm in The Old School-House, Castle Street. **Topic:** Gathering not Grandeur: Exploring the heritage of small, modest and temporary Churches in Ulster. **Speaker:** Dr Kevin Miller.

Baptism Dates— September to December 2026.

Bellaghy at 1pm

7 November, 5 December.

Greenlough at 4.15pm

24 October, 28 November, 19 December.

Bellaghy Parish Pastoral Council will meet on Tues 13 Oct @ 7.15pm.

St Mary's, Bellaghy / St Joseph's, Ballyscullion.

11 October 2026

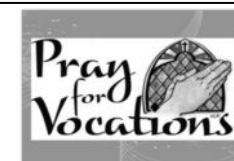
Twenty-Eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time.

The *Working Document* for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, taking place in Gormanston, Co Meath, on 17 October, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland. While the Assembly marks an important moment in the journey, the Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the *Working Document* and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?"

Please pray for all those taking part in the Assembly and for the guidance of the Holy Spirit, and scan the QR code to access the Working Document and find out more, and see www.synod.ie



We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."



Last week's Collection: £1,870.00

Building and Maintenance Fund Collection: £1075.00

Thank you.

The Foreign Missions Collection will be taken up at the Masses next weekend. Please use the envelope provided.



The Parish Office will be closed 12-16 October.